# Nicholas Best

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## COMPETENCIES AND SKILLS

- **Systems & Infrastructure:**
  - Network infrastructure & Systems Administrator
  - Hardware Assembly & Configuration
- **Cloud & Deployment:**
  - Docker
  - VPS managment
- **Programming & Version Control:**
  - Java, Python, Git, GitHub
- **Problem Solving & Continuous Learning:**
  - Building projects in a home lab, troubleshooting, exploring new tools

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

**Student at University of Wisconsin Stout**
Major: Cybersecurity

**CCNA**
(In Progress, Expected December 18, 2026)

## EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

**Cyber@Stout**
On a team training for events like NCAE, CCDC, and various CTFs.

**Yedi Ultimate**
Coach for the Ultimate Frisbee Club team at Stout.

**Honors**
Active member of honors.

## PROJECTS

- **Network Tunneling & VPS Proxy**
  - Made a tunneling solution using WireGuard and a VPS to establish bi-directional connectivity for a home lab restricted by a unsecure Double NAT.
  - Implemented Caddy as a reverse proxy with Authentik to enforce Single Sign-On and Multi-Factor Authentication across self hosted public services.
- **Cybersecurity Competitions**
  - Achieved a team national ranking of Top 3.5% (129th out of 3,634 teams) in National Cyber League.
  - Led a small team during the eCitadel (Defend the Box) defensive cybersecurity exercise.
- **Home Lab – Segmented Enterprise Network**
  - Designed and maintain a home lab following defense-in-depth principles, with network segmentation (VLANs), traffic monitoring, and internal self-hosted services.
- **CCNA Coursework – Hands-On Enterprise Network**
  - Built a full enterprise network topology on routers and switches for a semester-long midterm project, covering routing, switching, and segmentation as part of UW-Stout's CCNA coursework.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**UW-Stout IT Services - IT Technician** **Aug 2026 - Present**
Provide PC repair, quality assurance testing, and support for campus IT services.

**Independent Consultant - IT, AI & Security Consulting for small Law Firms** **Summer 2026**
Provided basic network and security setup, IT and AI consulting, password management setup, and basic security architecture for small law firm clients, adhering to strict client confidentiality requirements.

**Farm Hand** **Summer 2026**
Performed general farm labor including and manual field work.

**Pursuit Community Church - Volunteer Tech** **Jun 2023 - Aug 2025**
Set up and managed weekly tech equipment for live services.

**Pizza T - Lead Cook / Manager** **Jul 2024 - Feb 2025**
Trained and supported new staff. Adapted to multiple roles as needed.

**Pro Clear - Landscaping and window washing business** **Jul 2025 - Aug 2025**
Launched a service business; managed scheduling, pricing, and client referrals.